

Underwater gossip

Whales live in groups, or pods, and many talk to each other using squeaks, whistles, rumbles, or clicks. Beluga whales “speak” so much that they are sometimes called sea canaries.



Leaping dolphins

Dolphins are small whales. They are highly intelligent and curious, and are often seen leaping alongside boats at sea.



Bottlenose dolphin

Dolphins have very strong tails that help lift it high above the surface.

Dolphins leap out of the water to avoid enemies – leaping helps them to swim faster – or to herd fish by making loud splashes.



Spotted dolphin

Whales

Most whales look quite similar but a few have different features.



Narwhal: this whale has an enormous sword-like tusk, which is actually a tooth.



Porpoise: the porpoise is a toothed whale that looks similar to a dolphin.



Sperm whale: this whale holds the record for the deepest dive of any mammal.



Amazon river dolphin: this dolphin is one of the only freshwater whales.

Underwater babies

Whale and dolphin babies, called calves, grow in their mother's tummies, like other mammals. The calf drinks its mother's milk until it is old enough to eat solid food. Spotted dolphins, like this mother and calf, live in groups of up to 15.